MEMO · RECOMMENDATION

Which e-mail campaign should we send?

To: Marketing Manager
Re: E-mail campaign test, 64,000 customers
Date: 26 October 2026

RECOMMENDATION

Send the men's e-mail to everyone.

The men's e-mail earned the most revenue, and no customer group did better with the women's e-mail. A tailored campaign would add work for no measurable gain, and skipping the send would leave money on the table.

✓ Send the men's e-mail | ✗ Target by segment | ✗ Don't send

KEY NUMBERS

Ranges are 95% confidence intervals: the true value very likely lies within them. Revenue is measured over the 2 weeks after sending, compared with customers who got no e-mail.

Extra revenue per 10,000 e-mails: **men's e-mail**
+$7,700
range $4,900 – $10,600

Extra revenue per 10,000 e-mails: **women's e-mail**
+$4,200
range $1,700 – $6,900

Purchase rate with the men's e-mail (vs 0.57% with none)
1.25%
more than double · +0.50 to +0.86 pts

Gain from targeting vs men's e-mail to all, per 10,000
≈ $0
+$70 · −$1,800 to +$1,900

Profitability: assuming a 40% gross margin, the men's e-mail pays for itself as long as one e-mail costs less than **$0.31** ($0.19 in the worst plausible case).

THE TRADE-OFF

- **More buyers, smaller baskets.** The men's e-mail more than doubles purchases, but its median order is $67, compared with $88 for customers who got no e-mail. The extra buyers still more than make up for it.
- **The revenue lead over the women's e-mail is real but less precise.** The men's e-mail earns about $3,500 more per 10,000 e-mails (range $300 – $6,500). Its lead in visits and buyers is much clearer.
- **One campaign vs tailored campaigns.** The women's e-mail does work on customers who buy women's products, but for them it only *ties* with the men's e-mail. Targeting adds complexity without adding revenue.

LIMITATIONS

- **2008 US data** from one retailer. Customers and inboxes have changed since then, so treat the figures as directional.
- **Two-week window.** Later purchases, unsubscribes and list fatigue were not measured.
- **Unknown e-mail costs and margins.** Profit figures rely on an assumed 40% margin.
- **Segment results are exploratory.** Many customer groups were checked, so some differences can appear by chance.

NEXT STEPS

1. **Roll out the men's e-mail** and keep a 5–10% no-e-mail holdout in every send, so the effect is measured each time.
2. **Run a follow-up targeted test** with three groups of about 20,000 customers each: men's e-mail to all, matched e-mails (women's to women's-only buyers), and a new mixed-assortment e-mail. Customers who buy both lines responded most, which suggests broad creative could win.
3. **Bring in real margin and sending-cost data, and track results for 30–90 days,** including unsubscribes, to confirm longer-term profitability.

Data: Hillstrom MineThatData e-mail experiment (64,000 customers, randomized, 2008, USD).

Full analysis: notebooks 01–03 and stakeholder summary in the project repository.